



AGED, BLIND AND DISABLED MEDICAID 009

Table of Standards: Medicare Savings Program-Income

Supersedes: ABD 009 (04/01/2025)

Reference: ARM 37.83.201; 37.82.101; P.L. 100-360 (1988); P.L. 110-275 (MIPPA)

Overview: Use the following standards to determine financial eligibility for Medicare Savings Programs. Medicare Savings programs include *Qualified Medicare Beneficiaries (QMB)*, *Special Low Income Medicare Beneficiary (SLMB)* and *Qualified Individuals (QI)*.

INCOME:

Effective April 1, 2026, use the following standards to determine income eligibility for Medicare Savings Programs (MSP):

	QMB (100%)	SLMB (120%)	QI (135%)
Individual	\$0 to \$1,330	\$1330.01 to \$1,596	\$1,596.01 to \$1,796
Couple	\$0 to \$1,804	\$1,804.01 to \$2,164	\$2,164.01 to \$2,435

NOTE: In years in which there is an SSA COLA increase, on-going MSP recipients' SSA COLA increases are disregarded when received until the new MSP benefit standard is implemented for that year. These clients are entitled to receive continuous MSP benefits until the new MSP income limits are published. The system handles this disregard automatically.

APPLICATION:

Effective January 1, 2010, applications for Social Security Extra Help are considered applications for Medicare Savings Programs. Medicare beneficiaries may also apply for

Medicare Savings Programs through the traditional application process at any Office of Public Assistance and can apply online at apply.mt.gov. The State will be notified electronically of applications received by Social Security for Extra Help. These applications will be processed after that notification. If the LIS information indicates eligibility, no further verification is needed. If the information is questionable or indicates they MAY be eligible, verifications should be requested.

Effective Date: 04/01/2026